

SIZE 10–15 cm (4–6 in)

HABITAT Sandy and muddy shorelines

DISTRIBUTION Atlantic coast of W. Africa

DIET Opportunistic feeders, mainly on decaying plants and animals

✓ BEACHCOMBER

African rainbow crabs are most active at night when they emerge to forage, racing back to their burrows if disturbed. They eat plant and animal detritus, dead fish, and insects, leaving numerous little balls of sand which they have searched through for food.



*moveable dactylus
allows the claw to
operate as a pincer*

*static claw
against which the
dactylus moves*

*unequal sized
claw-bearing leg
used for feeding and
social interactions*

*buccal cavity
contains six pairs
of specialized
mouthparts*

*eye on thick,
elongated stalk*

*six-jointed
walking leg*